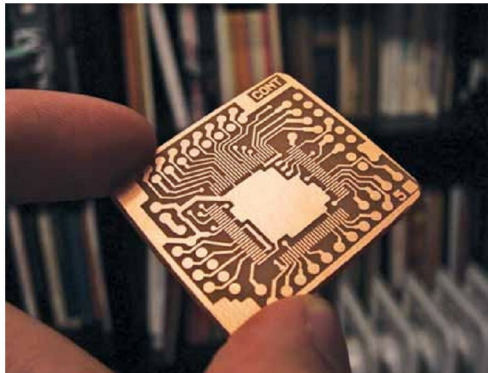


DESIGN YOUR CAREER ON A TINY WAFER

The \$10-billion electronics and chip design global market is growing at a rate of 6 to 10 per cent annually. With India evolving into one of the major players in this sector, job opportunities are tremendous



■ **MONIKA BHATI WITH INPUTS FROM JALAJA RAMANUNNI**

Are you a budding electronics engineer confused about which stream will help you get your dream job? If technology is your forte, chip design is one of the many options you can consider to ensure a fast-track career.

From your personal computer to your mobile phone to your brand new digital camera, almost every electronic gadget has a tiny silicon wafer called 'chip' behind its intelligent functions. Chip designers across the world strive to make faster and

cheaper chips that can automate part of or the entire function of mechanical devices.

Let's figure out the opportunities in chip design and what all you need to secure a job in this sector.

Major recruiters

The arrival of embedded systems (where intelligent devices are put inside everyday objects) and ubiquitous computing (where small computing devices proliferate to such an extent that even your shoes may be used to monitor your heartbeats) has given a boost to demand for professionals in chip design.

Today, as many as 23 of the top 25 semiconductor companies in the world have a strong presence in India. Also, there are more than 200 Indian semiconductor companies.

Some of the major recruiters are Texas Instruments (TI), PMC Sierra, Alliance Semiconductor, Analog Devices, Cadence, Synopsys, Cypress Semiconductor, HCL Technologies, Intel, Micron Tech, National Semiconductor, Philips Semiconductor, Qualcomm, Sasken, Moschip, Cradle Tech, Synplicity, Wipro and elfincohis.

Demand outstrips supply

Design firms in India continue to battle talent crunch. A recent report by the India Semiconductor Association (ISA), the apex trade body representing the Indian semiconductor and electronics industry, says that India's chip design industry is growing at a rate of 20 per cent annually. While global and domestic companies working in this sector have significantly increased their presence in the country, the design-aware talent shortage continues to plague the industry.

"There is no dearth of jobs for chip designers in India. In fact, there is a demand of about 6000 VLSI design engineers annually, but all the NITs and IITs totally produce only about 800 in a year. There is a huge gap between the demand and supply. The demand is so high that when one year is left before graduation, each student has at least two offers in hand from highly reputed organisa-